

Transcript of taped interview with Mr. and Mrs. [REDACTED] on November 19, 1972, at their home at [REDACTED]. The [REDACTED] were interviewed by T [REDACTED] and [REDACTED]. Transcribed 11/19/72, by TB.

Statement by Mrs. [REDACTED]:

[REDACTED], reference October 9, 1972, driving as passenger in Volkswagon bus east on Jericho Turnpike. Around Centereach, or just coming through Centereach, my husband and I both noticed a very bright light in the sky. He noticed it, I noticed it, without saying anything; at the next traffic light he mentioned it to me, "Did you see the bright light out there?" I said yes, and he said "Well, keep watching it."

It drew our attention because it's very open at this point--the sky--and there were stars out and everything but it was so much brighter, so much bigger, it was just so obvious.

Sylvia -- Was it dark?

Mrs C - Oh yes, it was evening, it was dark. It was so obvious from the stars that we kept watching it. We often look at the sky and see things but never anything we would report because we-- never came to a conclusion.

We kept watching it. As we drove east, we were watching it, I said "I don't think the darn thing is moving." Because if you're going one way and something's coming the other, you're gonna get--you know--closer together.

Then after watching it for a few minutes due to the trees or a turn in the road we lost sight of it, for a couple seconds. As we came around the bend, or the trees or ~~something~~ whatever it was there, I said "The darn thing is moving," because suddenly it's closer to us and then you could see it moving. And, of course, he's driving and I'm watching the thing steadily. . . all of a sudden I see a red light--a steady red light, normal size, normal everything like you would see on an airplane, the red light portion. But of course this white light is very big and bright, and I said "Oh, now I see a red light," and he said, "I don't," and then he looks up and he says, "Oh yeah, ~~now~~ I see it too." And then (in) a couple seconds I said, "Now I see a green light" on the other side of it.

These were placed approximately in my estimation--I am not the best judge of distance and size in the world, probably the worst--like if it was the wingtips of a plane, you know, with a red light on one side and a green light on the other. The lights stayed stationary, they did not go on and off, though the white light, you could see, was pulsating--it never went off, but sort of beat, like a heartbeat, a simulated heart beat.

He didn't see the green light and as I look back and piece everything together I can see why: this thing must be maneuvering in the sky and as I explained it my letter, it's rounded in the front and it's like a bat, a triangle, basically triangular shape. So as this thing maneuvers, if it goes down, or this way or that way, naturally you're gonna see only one light. It's only in certain positions you're gonna see both lights, the red and the green together.

When we'd seen both the red and the green light we said, oh, it must be an airplane. . . but we keep watching it because this white light is so outstanding, we're still wondering. Then as we're driving along I said to my husband, "You know," I said, "I'm not sure, ~~but~~ because this is how faint this other impression was, 'I see a--like a ring, the shape of either a ring or an outform, you know, like this (Gesture indicates a curve or arc), like sometimes you see a ring around the moon but you have to look. . . some nights it's clear and distinct, other nights you look and see the ring around the moon, you look again and ~~the~~ the ring is gone, and I got that impression. I said I see something circular, like a ring, I said this to him because he's driving, he's trying to glance-- I said I don't know, I'm not sure, then I said, "Yes, I am sure, I see something going-- like this (gestures in an arc)," I said it seems to have shape. But, you know--who knows what you're looking at, and we continue watching this. . . I see the green light now, I don't see the green light, but I always see the red light and the bright light, and we're watching it.

And then, as we got to the top of this hill before you come down into this place where the rug--the carpet place is, what is the name of that town, uh-Corum-- we must have lost sight of it for a minute because there are trees there; how I know there are trees there, we ran the route last night just, um--to see. The trees there, cause I never actually saw it, like you're on the road, this is the road and you're driving here and there are trees and stuff here, I never saw it actually approach, like go from over the trees to over the road, that's how low it is; I'm sitting in the Volkswagon and he's driving and I'm looking, and I look up-- actually with the Volkswagon bus, with the glass going just like this (indicates a slightly angled vertical) and nothing in front of you you're very high in those, and I look up and I look up and ~~suddenly looking~~ I'm suddenly looking right under ~~of~~ the belly of the thing, and that's when I yelled to him, "That's no airplane!" I said, "There are windows with lights under there," and I don't see any wings, I just saw this body there. At this point, looking up, you know, the excitement, it was like I'm sitting here, it would be like up there (gestures at a high angle almost overhead), and I'd go like this with the window (pushing her face right up against the glass), cause I had to push my head right to the front of the glass.

That's when I started yelling. I said, "Pull off the road, that's no airplane!" If you'd like to drive out there, we could. . . He pulled up as fast as he could, and there's a--at the edge of the thing (road) goes right up like this, a little hill, and ~~xxxx~~ with weeds and such on it, and I ran up that embankment and looked and by that time, with him pulling forward, you know, stopping the car, and this thing going this way (the opposite direction), because it was, so, you know, we were going this way (east) and that was going that way (west southwest), then, when I stood on this embankment, and I'd stand there and this thing would be like in proportion (at an angle of ab 70-80 degrees WSW of the zenith--TB), I'm looking at it, say this is the back of the triangle, from the rear, at this point I can't see under here (the bottom), you see it's not up this high to me (there is much gesturing with arms as to heights and angles at this point--TB), in relationship, it's like this (looking at the pad approximately end on), I don't really see anymore the--he can see the lights underneath, because of where he was sitting, lower, sticking his head out. I saw it, like this is the back of the triangle, which was straight, it's very dark, this thing, as I said if it was advertising it was ~~xxxxxxxxxxxx~~ the worst piece of advertising in the world, because it had everything ~~xxxxxxxx~~ to camouflage it, and look how long we'd seen it, as you'll see when we ride along (the route--TB). You didn't know what you were looking at, then you thought it was an airplane, and then you thought it was, I can see why people describe different things so curious, because you see it from all different angles.

I look up and suddenly I see these. . . suddenly it registered, these things were always there, there's these two great big antennas or poles sticking up with what would be considerably narrower in diameter going across the top. If it would be poles it would be in relationship to wire, or a fat poles ~~xxxxxxxx~~ to a skinny pole, that was connected across the top. That gave it a very home-made appearance. The way that rear, with the poles, cause I said to myself. . . it looks like someone made it in their garage. This didn't seem as--as smooth, it looked like, you know, an added thing.

And as I was standing there it suddenly dawns on me that I don't hear anything-- don't hear a--I says, "I don't hear anything; there's no noise!"

TB - Can I interrupt you here? I want to get an idea of the size of the object, as you were standing on the top of the bluff. Can you hold your hands apart as if you were measuring the distance at arm's length?

Mrs O - ~~xxxxxxxxxxxx~~ Oh, I'd say it was that wide.

TB - A good two feet - over two feet. . . a good 30 inches.

Mrs O - When we rode back last night and looked at the spot, I'm thinking--as I say I am not a very good judge of height or distance -- but looking at it in the spot again last night--the first time we've been back--it must have been lower than I, lower than what I said in the letter than what you were saying, it might have been higher, because I judged it, you know, the telephone poles running along the side of the road

Mrs C - Yeah, but what interested me was that it was so well camouflaged, whatever it was, it didn't want to be seen anymore than was absolutely necessary, obviously, because the metal, or whatever the body was made out of, was very dark; it was either a very, very dark grey or black, like a gun metal, or black--

Mrs C - The light on the front, yes, and yet you could only, and however this darn thing was designed, you could only be in certain positions to see the lights in the windows underneath.

FB - Was there still some light in the sky at the time? Were there clouds ~~at that~~
~~time~~ that night?

Mrs. C -- I don't think-- I think it was pitch dark. What time was it now? It was late, it was after dinner-- We went to golf (etc.). . .

20 ES - And what was the duration, when you first saw the light to the point - it - 20 minutes?

Mrs C - No, from home, and after we had arrived quite a ways before we spotted the light, so maybe the whole deal was ten minutes -

Mrs C - I could have probably stood there longer and still seen it going more, except he made me get back in the car. Afterwards you think what you should have done, you know, stayed longer. But that was the strange thing--

TB - All right, that's fine. That's very good Mrs Clapp, thank you.

Statement by Mr Ralph Olapp

My name is Ralph Olapp. On November 9--uh, October 9 at, uh, around 7 o'clock, my wife and I left for the Corum Rug Works, to look over rug samples. We were traveling east on Route 25. Along about two-thirds of the way through Centereach we stopped at a red light, and looking up I saw an extremely bright light, low down. I had the feeling ~~xxxxxx~~ maybe it was about ten times a star, uh, ten times the size of a normal star, maybe half the size of a full moon, but looking like a star and very bright. And our thoughts were so much on other things that I may have seen it before and not realized it. Even seeing that I didn't realize fully what I was looking at, but I did mention to my wife, "Look at that very bright light." We traveled for five or six minutes further eastward, going about 40 miles an hour, and seeing it intermittently. I could only see it glancing ~~xx~~ quickly up because I was driving. Just before a big hill in Corum -- the big hill before Corum -- starting up it, my wife mentioned seeing a red and green light. I only saw the red light. Then as we approached the hill, going up the hill, we lost sight of it completely for awhile. At the top of the hill, my wife said something to the effect of, "That is no airplane. It has windows underneath, I see windows underneath! Stop the car, stop the car!"

I pulled over soon as I could, and, uh--very narrow/shoulder. The car, the Volkswagon was partially over the edge of the road, at a curve, on the top of the hill, and was in a dangerous position, so I did not get out. She got out immediately and was observing it. I opened the window and ~~was~~ craned my neck upward, and what I saw, approaching slightly to the left and to the front, and not quite overhead, was an elongated ellipse of lights, with a dark mass in between. I did not see the specific bat shape. I saw the partial--partially the ~~xxxxxx~~ bright, front light, a slight curvature, but the main impression was a big arc of lights underneath this dark body, curving backward.

TB - Square lights?

Mr C - I could not tell whether they were square or round, just individual lights going around in an elliptical --

TB - In a single row?

Mr C - In a double row, in like an ellipse, going backwards

Sylvia - How many, would you say?

Mr. C - That's hard to say, because you're not thinking at the time. Maybe five or six on a side - could have been more.

TB - Five or six double?

Mr C - Yes, on either side, going around.

Sylvia - In a single row, going around -

TB - Regarding the double row of lights, can you explain that?

Mr C - A single row on either side, forming an ellipse, or an elongated horseshoe; that's the way I described it to the wife, an elongated horseshoe. It was very uncomfortable, straining my neck upward, ~~xxxxx~~ so I only got short glimpses of it and at the approach of a car, down the hill away, I told my wife to get in and we left--we left to go down to the rug works.

TB - About how much time had elapsed at that point?

Mr C - I would say we were at the top of the hill looking maybe a minute, maybe a minute and a half, could have been two minutes.

TB - On the ~~xxxxxx~~ hill?

Mr C - On the hill itself! At the time I didn't estimate height, or speed, but I had the feeling it was of a very large object, it was low down and I'd thought it was maybe a thousand feet overhead. But going back, it was going extremely slow, and soon as we got home I thought about it and I would say that it, again at arm's length, forming a 90 degree arc, it, uh, maybe six seconds elapsed, from hand to hand, in a 90 degree arc.

TB - You mean it was six seconds, six seconds to go--

Mr C -

Mr. C - it took to go this distance of the 90-degree arc, holding the hands up.

TB - Right.

would have said, I had the feeling

Mr C - Right, about that. And as far as size, I ~~would have said~~ it was something more than 8 or ten inches at arm's length. Something over--it might have been more, but certainly not less than eight inches at arm's length. It was quite a sizable thing.

TB - And your estimate (Mrs. C's) is more to 30 inches, so it varies between 8 to 30.

Mrs C - Well, maybe you should go by him rather than me because (laughing) I admit on not being a good judge.

Mr C - She had the advantage of actually being outside the car and looking at it steadily, while I just craned my neck upward from time to time.

Mrs C - It's interesting about the windows underneath, like just where they were placed. When I first spotted the window, when I was still in the car, when we were moving, when I first noticed this overhead, all I know is that I saw windows underneath the body. It wasn't, like, on the sides, it was underneath the body, and I couldn't really tell you if I saw eight or ten or five or six and I couldn't tell you, like, if they were in a row. All I know is that suddenly I got, you know, you get so ~~excited~~ excited, you know, you look, you know, this is after we've lost sight of it, all of a sudden I look up and ~~it's~~ it's right over me and I ~~know~~ just know I suddenly see windows all with lights in them, you know, all the windows were lit.

TB - Is it possible these lights came on at a point between your last having seen it through the windshield and the point of getting out and viewing it from the outside of the car? (No ho--trick question #1!)

Mrs C - Oh, I was in the car when I first saw the lights, that's how--

TB - You were in the car?

~~and I thought I was in the car when I first saw the lights, that's how--~~

Mrs C - I was in the car. That's why I yelled, That's no airplane, I see windows and lights underneath the thing. I was in the car when I looked up.

TB - Now the shape of these lights, can you - do you have any impression of them? Were they square, round, octagonal, triangular, just globs?

Mrs. C - No, they had a shape. In my impression - I couldn't swear to it - in my impression I would say they were rectangular shape, not too big, any individual one.

Mr C - I had the distinct impression, feeling, they were a highly geometric pattern, and that they were an elongated rectangle. I didn't, you know--thinking on it, soon's I got home, which was relatively a short time after seeing it, thinking about it, visualizing it, it appeared like ~~an~~ elongated rectangles.

Mrs C - It might be interesting to you people, too, that when we got home here, in the car coming back we were just excited and really didn't say too much, I think we were both thinking, and we got home here, we refrained from discussing it until we both wrote our individual impressions. We purposefully refrained from discussing it so we wouldn't - influence each other. outside.

Mr C - And we spent a great amount of time getting a composite of what Grace saw/
doing ~~gathering~~ many many sketches until finally she said that's just about what I saw.

Mrs C - ~~That's~~ And he would draw something what I saw and I'd say, No that's not what I saw, and the only thing I let him leave was the windows. . .because the windows were there, I had seen them and then he saw them from his angle. I was ^{just} going to say that it was because of the elevation from where I was standing, the relation to where I was standing when I was out of the car I no longer saw the windows because it must have been in relation to, like, this eye level (gestures), rather than to this eye level, because then I'm looking up, it's not at my eye level, but I'm looking at a --a -

TB - High angle.

Mrs C - Yeah. The thing had no sides, no sides. Like it didn't have a top, a bottom and sides. It's true when they say--

TB - It's two dimensional/, in other words, flat?

TB - So you can't be sure then, when you came out, that the object--the light you f-- you saw finally, was the same thing? Or are you sure that it was?

Mr C - I can't be sure ~~that's the same thing~~

TB - You couldn't be sure. Mrs Clapp, how about you?

Mrs C - Well, if I had to swear to it, I couldn't swear to it. I'd like to think it was the same light, I felt that night it was the same night it was the same light--

TB - But there is some question in your mind?

Mrs C - There's a question, yeah, there's a question in my mind; the only thing there isn't a question in my mind is, I know I saw this thing from the car and when I stodd, you know, when you definitely see-- I mean there's a big difference when you know you actually see an object.

TB - I'm thinking that Venus would have been--

Mr C - Venus-- (TB reached down here to be sure it was on and turned it off)

TB - I didn't mean to interrupt you, Mr. Clapp. Tell us about Venus.

Mr C - Well, she, ~~um~~ after she left the rug works, she kept arguing that was the same object, going away, and I mentioned, I had the feeling it could be a star, that Venus was off in that direction, altho it was a very bright Venus, and looked a little larger, it could very well have been--

Mrs C - However, though, when I went into the store, and looked up, and you looked out there, you got out ~~and~~ for a minute and looked ~~at it~~, I said, "There it is," we see it, there's that light again. Then I went in the store and I was at the most five minutes, cause I had to walk way in the back to return the sample that the salesman, and back-- um, and I came out, I still see it but it was further away from when I seen it when I ~~xxxx~~ got out of the car at the rug works-- does Venus move that far

TB - Well, can you identify Venus when you see it?

Mrs C - No.

Mr C - I can.

TB - You can. But did you see Venus and the light, simultaneously, or just--

Mrs C - Did you consciously look for Venus?

Mr C - I didn't consciously look for Venus

Mrs C - I'm lucky if I can find the big dipper, I mean, ~~xx~~ I don't know-- when I look up--

Sylvia - Can you compare the brightness of the windows to the original light? Was it as bright as the original bright light?

Mrs C - No. No, it was like, as I say, if you were here and you looked over to the next block and the lady had the light lit in her room, you know there's a light lit in that room, but light doesn't come out of the building--

Sylvia - You said this took place in the dark--

Mrs C - Um hmm--

Sylvia - Night had fallen. Uh, at the point where you saw the two antenna, antenna-like objects, by what light did you see those?

Mrs C - I don't know what ~~light~~ I saw it by-- I was just looking at

Mr C - We were looking west -

Mrs C - I don't know what light I saw, as I say, you hadda-- it was-- everything about the thing was that you shouldn't see it, because those things were dark, too.

Sylvia - Were those things darker than the sky?

Mrs C - Yes, the object was darker than the sky.

Mr C - The sky was a very black-blue, not black on as a cloudy, a late cloudy night, but uh, a real dark blue, as after sunset, there was still a tiny bit of light, but it's real dark. I think, I think, uh, maybe these, uh, sketches would help identify what--

Sylvia - How did you feel when you saw this object?

Mrs C - I'm glad you asked that. Uh, different than I thought I would. It all-- because it happens and you're ~~not~~ prepared for it, you think you're prepared for ~~it~~ a thing like this and you're not, because you're not thinking of that--

Mrs C - Yeah, it was like if you put two saucers together, naturally you're not gonna have sides. You know, no-- no--

TB - No rim.

Mrs C - No rim.

Strange voice - Callavee, we'll just file it.

Mr C - But you just did mention you had-- you distinctly saw a flat, uh--

Mrs C - The back was flat. The back went right like that, straight, and then these antennas up, and whatever connected it, of course, at the top of the antennas, and they were quite tall in relationship to the, uh -- to the back--

TB - Were they as tall as the object was wide? Taller, or shorter?

Mrs C - At least as tall as the object was wide, across the back, possibly taller.

TB - To get the sequence of the final part of the sighting now, you left the scene where you got out of the car and went on to the rug store--

Mrs C - Right, which is just a very short distance away --

TB - And it was still visible at the drug-- uh, rug store?

Mrs C - Yes, and that's the strange thing, though. From the drug-- from the rug-- carpet place, after all, it's going the other way, right?

TB - Yeah --

Mrs C - It's visible, but only that big white light is visible again. How the heck the white light could be in the front and we're seeing it from the back, I don't know, but we saw the big white light, still moving off in the same direction.

TB - Uh huh--

Mrs C - I mean its, it's ~~just~~--

TB - It appeared going away as it appeared coming close to you, just the big white light.

Mrs C - (Shakes head, yes.)

TB - And you could see nothing of the red or green light at this point, or nothing of the darker silhouette of the object.

Mrs C - No, no. Because as I figure it now, piecing it together as you say, if you have a triangle like this (holding up pad), and this is the rear section (the back of the pad, with the point of a triangle moving forward--TB) and (these are) the points (the two ^{POSS} anterior angles), the lights were, like, not on the back, they were like, must have been more, like, here (to the front of the two ^{POSS} anterior angles)--

TB - The red and green lights?

Mrs C - Yeah, they musta been more there, because, uh - they weren't like, uh--

TB - At the rear--

Mrs C - They weren't back there, they must have been, like, where it makes this apex (at the rear of the two anterior sides), they musta been like that, you know--

TB - Uh hmm.

Mr C - She kept pointing to this a, this um-- what looked like a very large star. It was nowhere near as large as when we first saw it, coming. It may have picked up speed or been a considerable distance away by that time. I personally couldn't, uh-- couldn't have sworn that it was the same object, at the Corum rug works-- she was in there about five minutes, and came out--

Mrs C - All I did was return a sample --

Mr C - We, uh - already

TB - You saw it, you saw it twice then: you saw it when you got out of the car at the rug work, as the bright light you saw originally--

Mrs C - Um humm.

TB - Then you went into the rug works--

Mrs. C - I did, he stayed in the car. I just ran in to return a sample piece that we had borrowed.

TB - All right, did you keep it in--in sight, Mr. Clapp, then, while you were out in--

Mr C - No, I didn't, because I, ~~because the~~ car was, it was a fairly cold night and ~~isn't~~ was facing the opposite way, so I didn't keep sight of it--

Mrs C - He was just anxious to get home again (laughs)--

uh -- you're thinking of watching the light and all, but still in your mind you're still thinking of the carpet you bought that day, and this sort of thing-- you know, it's an exciting thing, and much going on -- and, uh, I just wanted to get out and see it, and just excited ~~about~~ but, I thought I would be more-- because I get excited, you know, about things, anyway, and, uh - I ~~know it sounds silly~~ ~~always~~ always--I know it sounds silly, but I always said if I ever saw one I was going to jump up and down and wave, let them know I was glad to see them, but I never even thought of doing it, I mean, I was so busy pointing (laughs), I said maybe they thought I was waving at them--

Sylvia - Did you have any fearfulness?

Mrs C - No.

Sylvia - No anxiety, no --uh, worry, no sense of hostility--

Mrs C - No, none whatsoever.

Sylvia - What about Mr. Clapp?

Mrs Clapp - Well, I can't believe that he didn't get out of the car. And neither can he. He looks back and bangs his head against the wall every day. As he said --

Mr C - As I ~~walked~~ was going along, even though -- even though it was a big light I kept uh, thinking in terms of airplanes. It wasn't until the last minute I saw the, uh, the large mass and the lights that I-- dispelled the notion of an airplane. And I think I said well, I'm glad Gracie finally saw one of these UFOs. Previously she said I can't get excited until one lands on the lawn and ~~says~~ ^{says} "I am a flying saucer."

Mrs C - Yeah, I, uh, that-- a humorous thing. I had Rita-(?) here made a kite ~~once~~ for a ~~flyin~~ contest once, for a kite thing, and he did, he made a like a flying saucer shape but I made him put on it, "Yes Lady, I'm a flying saucer," like that, cause I used to always kid, cause we are well read on the subject and in my heart I do believe in such things, but you always have the element of doubt, you know, you figure, Well -- and I used to always kid, I ~~said~~ said I'll believe it when one goes by and says, "Yes, lady, I'm a flying saucer," so it was sort of like a family joke, and that's why I thought I'd be, you know--

EB - Well, there was something in this sighting, then, that said to you, "Yes, lady, I am a flying saucer--"

Mrs C - Oh, yes-- to me it was--

EB - without spelling it out --

Mrs C - Without spelling it out, yes, definitely. All I, -- if you wanna be-- I mean, very scientific, and everything, you always have to leave room for doubt, I mean -- it was something, in my knowledge, that does not fly -- is not, you know, as far as public knowledge goes, it was not a helicopter, it was not an airplane, it was not a blimp, it was not anything the average person knows that flies. I mean, if you could prove to me that there's some ~~thing~~ of experimental-- which there very ~~likely~~ likely may be, uh -- going on, and this is their experimental thing, they sure didn't want anybody to know about their experiment, that's all I can say, because as I say, this thing was -- they did everything so you really shouldn't pick it out of the sky - uh, that I would allow for. But this was not an airplane, was not a helicopter, was not a blimp, was not not a-- swamp grass, or gas or whatever it is, it wasn't air pollution, or anything else, you know, like that.

TB - Start that again.

Mr C - Four or five years ago at Long Lake, Maine, we were camping ^{ed,} and, um, at a site, and from the ^{map} map, the lake was exactly a half a mile wide, uh, as near as could be scaled, ~~from the map~~. Uh, the mountains beyond were maybe two or three hundred feet high and we were sitting on the beach front, um, with a-- clear view of the lake, and either side was bounded by very very thick pines, extending maybe ~~from~~ at an angle from your eyesight to the limit of the, uh, pines on either side, of 90 degrees, and, uh, I suddenly saw this extremely bright light. It was about the ^{length} length of a ^{coin} coin held at arm's length -- a dime, rather, at that length and maybe half as wide. It was the brightest light I'd ever seen. It was ~~about as bright as an acetylene torch, almost like an acetylene~~

like

almost ~~xxxxxxxx~~ an acetylene torch, that brightness, and I estimated it went the 90 degrees of arc in a second or less, extremely fast, and large, sort of elongated. And, uh, it was in front of the hills, so it was over the lake, and X my impression was over the further end of the lake, so I was able to do a little mental mathematics, and, uh, estimate the size at ^{maybe} 25 or 30 feet in diameter, if it were a half mile away, and, uh, maybe traveling from two thousand to 2800 miles an hour. But that was something that wasn't a plane - it went far too fast for a plane, it was much too bright a light, it could only have been an unknown, a UFO.

TB - Had you considered the possibility of a fireball meteor?

Mr C - I'd thought of that, but this traveled -- it was so low, uh, over the lake, maybe a hundred over the lake, and traveling so perfectly parallel, that, uh, it was extremely unlikely, in my mind, that it was

Mrs C - I was thinking about ~~why~~ you still never have said a thing--

Mr C - I was-- it was -- (over above)

Mrs C - Here, you see, you got a big light, you're looking ^there, and you're looking up there--

Mr C - You could see it against the background of the --

TB - But you didn't see it?

Mrs C - I didn't see it, no, that's how fast it must have been, cause I looked (laughing) and it was go-- you can

TB - Is there any way you can, uh, establish the date more precisely, cause if there was amateur flyover that night, we could/ ~~may~~ check records and probably find other reports.

Mrs C - What year did we go there?

TB - Was it after this incident out in Long Island, in '66? (The series of sightings, in late October, 1966, that was responsible for arousing the Clapps' interest in the subject of UFOs--TB)

Mrs C - Oh, no -- wait a minute--

Mr C - Oh, no, it must have been before that. We got the, uh, Volkswagon in -- this was before we got the Volkswagon, wasn't it? No, after--

Mrs C - I don't remember--

Mr C - We got the Volkswagon in 65, and-- It might have been 1966 that we went up there.

Mrs. C - Long Lake, now which one was Long Lake?

Mr C - Maine--

Mrs C - Oh, Long Lake was Maine, we/ came down from - was that coming back from Arcadia, or back from Baxter, where-- when did we stop at Long Lake

Mon C - Could you look it up in the album?

Mrs C - Yeah, bicycle built for two. Do we have any pictures of that? You can judge by the age of the kids.

Daughter - We went to Colorado in '66.

Mrs C - But we went up north, before that, then. We made so many trips up to the north - I remember Long Lake is when we went to those bicycles built for two, and I struggled with them. . .

(To cut this short, it was determined that they had spent the first week of July, 1966, up on Prince Edward Island, "July 4th weekend," and came south to Long Lake, Maine, about the second week in July, 1966--TB.)

(The next section is Mrs C's description of the scene in the rug store, prior to her last view--the possible spurious sighting-- of the object; it is amusing, but adds little data to the report. "Two salesmen are sittin' there like globs, ya know, just sittin' there. . ." It establishes that she spent about five minutes in the store, before she came back outside. She had put the object out of her mind, at this point.)

Sylvia - Did you forget about it while you were in the store? Did you forget about the object?

Mrs C - Yeah --

Sylvia - You put it out of your mind, so that you--

Mrs C - Yeah, cause I figured I wanted to get rid of this-- hunk of carpet, and everything else, I've no more interest in this store because, as I say, early in the afternoon we wind up we went to another store and ordered this carpeting (indicates the new carpet they just finished laying in the living room).

Sylvia - Then you disposed of the sample and you walked out of the carpet store--

Mrs C - Then I --

Sylvia - What was the first thing you did?

Mrs C - Looked up in the sky (laughing) and I said the damn thing's still there, but it was further away again, the light.

Sylvia - At that point it was further away.

Mrs C - Further away.

TB - At that point can you be sure you weren't seeing Venus?

Mrs C - No, I couldn't be sure, I couldn't be positive, I mean I have to be honest--

TB - I'm not even sure Venus was an evening star at that point--it may have been a morning ~~star~~, but this can be checked --

Sylvia - What day of the week was it?

Mrs C - Monday. That I know, cause it was the holiday.

That ends the recorded statements. Some of this was clarified later, as we drove over the route the Clappe took on the way to the Coram Rug Works on October 9, 1972, somewhere between 7:30 and 8 p.m. (the sighting occurred closer to 8 p.m.--TB). I had a map with me during the ride and carefully marked off the following points:

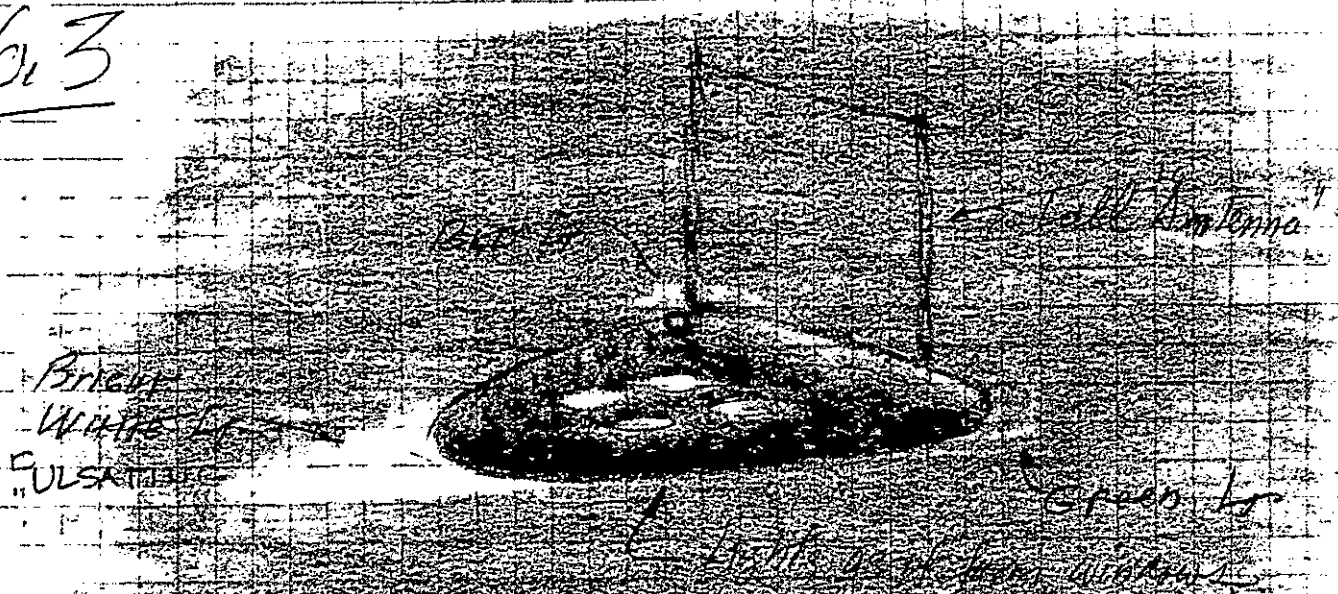
1. The point at which they first saw the light, ahead and slightly north of east, along Route 25 (Middle County Road, and extension of Jericho Turnpike), about two miles east of Centereach, L.I.
2. The point where the light appeared to be approaching, or getting larger.
3. The point when Mrs C first observed the red, then green, lights.
4. The point where they lost the object, between Seldon and Coram, as they ascended the small hill between those two very small hamlets.
5. The point at the top of the Hill where the object suddenly reappeared over the trees lining the left of the road, and crossed Route 25 at a narrow angle in the direction toward the west southwest, and where they stopped the car, and Mrs C got out to watch.
6. And the point at the Coram Rug Works, when they last saw the light.

On the hilltop, the north side of Route 25 is filled with large trees, and a few abandoned cabins; the south side of the highway is lined with telephone poles, and is wide open, with fields extending off into the distance. It is sparsely settled, until you get down to the foot of the hill, a quarter of a mile away, toward the Coram crossroads, where there are a number of houses and commercial establishments.

(See map for more details.)

~~XXXXXXXXXX~~
Transcribed 11/19-20/72

No. 3



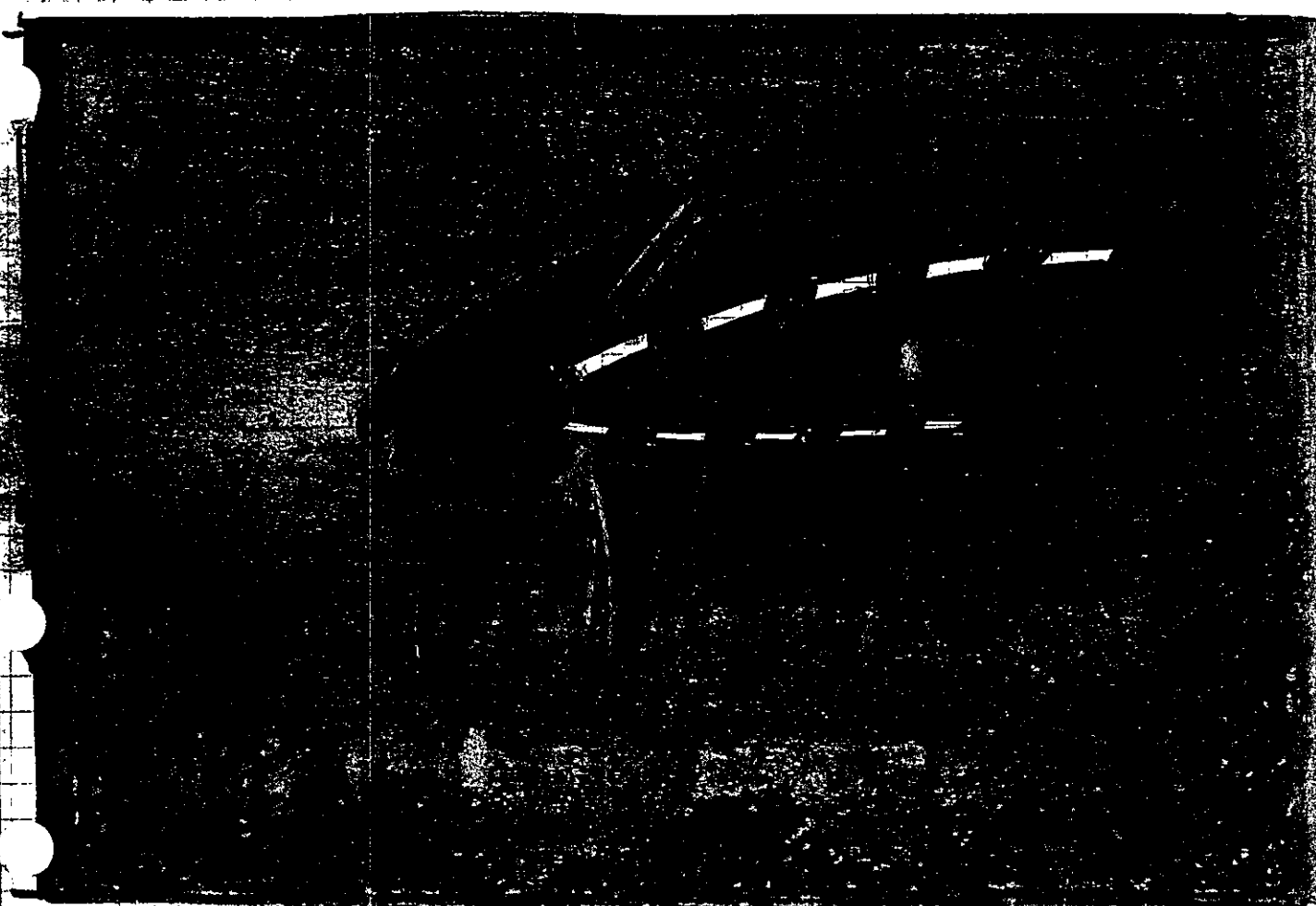
- OBJECT AS IT WAS LEAVING - FLYING VERY SLOWLY FROM EAST N.E TO WEST S.W.

- OBJECT APPEARED APPROX 8" LONG & 6" WIDE IF HELD AT ARMS LENGTH WHEN DIRECTLY OVERHEAD. SPEED APPEARED TO BE 3 FT OF ARC AT ARMS LENGTH IN SIX SECONDS.

WHAT [REDACTED] SAW STANDING OUTSIDE CAR AT 7:55 PM -

Object as seen by [REDACTED] looking upward
through car window & [REDACTED] standing
outside of car. @ 7.55 P.M.

No. 2.



OBJECT ALMOST DIRECTLY OVERHEAD AND
SLIGHTLY TO OUR SIDE.